



MODULE 4

Feedback & Communication

How do you give feedback — and what does the player actually hear?

CORE THEORY

Feedback is the most powerful learning tool in sport — but also the most misused. Research by Hattie & Timperley (2007) shows that effective feedback focuses on the task and learning process, not the person. The SBI model (Situation–Behavior–Impact) provides structure: describe the situation, the specific behavior, and the impact. Positive-corrective feedback (not the sandwich method) is 4-5x more effective than purely critical feedback with youth athletes.

Source: Hattie & Timperley (2007) · Magill (2011) · Amorose (2007) · Kim Scott (2017)

"Feedback is a gift — but only when the recipient experiences it that way."

— Sheila Heen

"The problem isn't that people disagree. The problem is that they don't say it honestly."

— Kim Scott

SELF-REFLECTION

- 1 What is the ratio of positive to corrective feedback you give during a training? Do you think that's accurate?
- 2 Do you give feedback on the person or on the behavior? Give a recent example of each.
- 3 Which player on your team systematically receives less feedback from you? Why?
- 4 How do you react when a player contradicts or doesn't accept your feedback?
- 5 When did you last ask a player for feedback on your own coaching?

NOTES

**BOOKS**

- **Radical Candor**
Kim Scott
Why: Care personally, challenge directly. The best framework for honest yet respectful feedback. Chapter 3 is gold.
- **Thanks for the Feedback**
Douglas Stone & Sheila Heen
Why: How to give AND receive feedback. Essential for coaches who also want to grow themselves.
- **Nonviolent Communication**
Marshall Rosenberg
Why: Communicating from needs, not blame. Changes how you talk to players and parents.

**VIDEO'S / TED TALKS**

- **How to Give and Receive Feedback**
Sheila Heen (Harvard)
[youtube.com/watch?v=FQNbaKKYk_Q](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FQNbaKKYk_Q)
Three types of feedback. Learn which ones you give and which you should be giving.
- **Radical Candor**
Kim Scott (FirstRound Talk)
[youtube.com/watch?v=4yODaLLQ2IM](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4yODaLLQ2IM)
The 2x2 grid: ruinous empathy vs. obnoxious aggression vs. manipulative insincerity vs. radical candor.

**PODCASTS**

- **Coaching Real Leaders**
HBR Podcast — having difficult feedback conversations
hbr.org/podcasts/coaching-real-leaders
- **Dare to Lead with Brené Brown**
Episode on honest conversations and "clear is kind"
brenebrown.com/podcast

⚡ ACTION THIS WEEK

Give specific SBI feedback to three players this week: "In [situation] you did [behavior] — the impact was [effect]." No judgment, no interpretation.

One communication habit I want to change in my coaching:
